

Software Design and Architecture

[Software Architecture] – Week 03, L02

Lecture Outlines

➤ **Software Architecture Process**

- ✓ Understand and Evaluate Requirements
- ✓ Design the Architecture
- ✓ Evaluate the Architecture
- ✓ Document the Architecture
- ✓ Monitor and control implementation

➤ **Requirements Engineering**

- ✓ Elicitation
- ✓ Analysis
- ✓ Specification
- ✓ Validation

➤ **What's next..**

Software Architecture Process

- On a larger scale, the **process** for creating software architectures can be executed using the following tasks:
 - ✓ Understand and evaluate requirements
 - ✓ Design the architecture
 - ✓ Evaluate the architecture
 - ✓ Document the architecture
 - ✓ Monitor and control implementation
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Understand and Evaluate Requirements

➤ Requirements engineering

- ✓ The discipline within software engineering that is concerned with the systematic approach to requirements specification, mainly through the following activities:

- Elicitation
- Analysis
- Specification
- Validation

➤ Software architects spend a great deal of time working with software requirements.

- ✓ Even after requirements are specified, software architects find themselves going back and forth between requirements and design.
 - ✓ In some cases, architects are completely immersed(**Deep and involved**) in the requirements phase, playing a key role in the specification of requirements.
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Understand and Evaluate Requirements (Elicitation)

➤ Elicitation

- ✓ Activity that deals with identifying stakeholders, uncovering what the customer needs and wants, and with determining the non-functional requirements.
 - ✓ Begins by identifying all sources of information that can be used to generate requirements.
 - ✓ Different sources can have similar but different visions for the system.
 - Common sources of requirements include:
 - Stakeholders
 - Goals
 - Domain knowledge
 - Operational and organizational environment
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Understand and Evaluate Requirements (Elicitation)

➤ **Common Elicitation Techniques**

- ✓ Interviews
 - ✓ Facilitated meetings
 - ✓ Observation
 - ✓ Scenarios
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Understand and Evaluate Requirements (Analysis)

➤ Analysis

- ✓ Requirements are analyzed in their raw form to address and solve issues such as requirements that are *contradicting*, *incomplete*, *vague*, or just *wrong*.
 - ✓ **Extra:** For example, if one requirement states the system must operate 24/7, but another says it needs daily maintenance downtime, these are contradictory and need to be resolved.
 - ✓ Allows architects to clear the air in regard to what needs to be done before devising more detailed designs.
 - ✓ The following tasks can be performed during analysis:
 - Requirement **classification**
 - Requirement **prioritization**
 - Requirement **negotiation**
 - Conceptual **modeling**
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Extra: Example: Real Software Example: Banking App Development

Imagine a team is developing a mobile banking app, and the initial requirements include:

Requirement	Issue Found	Resolution
R1: Secure login	Vague – “secure” not defined (could mean password, 2FA, fingerprint, etc.).	Clarify the exact login method with stakeholders.
R2: Fast & seamless user experience	May conflict with R1 because strong security can slow down the app.	Optimize design to balance speed and security (e.g., efficient encryption, smart caching).
R3: Multiple payment methods	Incomplete – doesn’t specify which methods (credit card, PayPal, crypto, etc.).	Define the required payment methods clearly.
R4: 24/7 availability	Contradicts the need for system updates/maintenance that may cause downtime.	Plan for rolling updates or redundant servers to keep service available.

Understand and Evaluate Requirements (Analysis)

➤ Requirement classification

- ✓ Performed for identifying the nature of each requirement
 - Functional vs. non-functional
 - Product vs. process
 - Imposed vs. Derived

Criteria	Description
Functional vs. Non-Functional	Classification that differentiates between requirements that specify the functional aspects of the system vs. the ones that place constraints on how the functional aspects are achieved.
Product vs. Process	Requirement placed on the system product vs. requirements placed on the process employed to build such product.
Imposed vs. Derived	Requirements imposed by stakeholders vs. requirements that are derived by the development team.

Extra:

1. Functional vs. Non-Functional

- **Functional** → What the system does.

Example: “The system must allow users to log in”.

- **Non-Functional** → How the system behaves.

Example: “The system must load within 2 seconds.”

2. Product vs. Process

- **Product requirement** → what the delivered software must have or do.

Example: “The app must support online payments.”

- **Process requirement** the **way of developing** that product (the steps, methods, or standards used).

Example: “The app must be developed using Agile methodology.”

3. Imposed vs. Derived

- **Imposed** → Given directly by stakeholders.

Example: “The app must run on iOS and Android.”

- **Derived** → Identified by the development team to meet higher goals.

Example: “To support both platforms, the app should use Flutter framework.”

Understand and Evaluate Requirements (Analysis)

➤ Requirement prioritization and negotiation

- ✓ Helps identify the most important functions of the software system.
- ✓ When done properly, it can help refine the projected schedule by determining which requirements need to be processed first.
- ✓ Can be used to determine different builds of the software
- ✓ Can help during negotiation when conflicts between requirements are identified.

Extra:

1. **Identify key functions** → e.g., login security is more important than adding a theme color.
 2. **Refine schedule** → do critical features first (payment, security) → less urgent features later.
 3. **Plan builds/versions** → Release 1: core features, Release 2: chatbot + extras.
 4. **Support negotiation** → if conflict → focus on security now, move chatbot to future update.
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Understand and Evaluate Requirements (Analysis)

➤ **Conceptual modeling**

- ✓ Conceptual models are created to further identify the requirements by understanding their context, discovering the bounds of the software system, and conceptualizing how the system interacts with its environment.
- ✓ In many projects, this is where architectural design begins, since system decomposition is essential to developing effective conceptual models. (important)

➤ **Extra: Conceptual Modeling**

➤ **Purpose:** Understand requirements, system context, and boundaries.

➤ **Boundaries:** Decide what the system will include and exclude.

✓ *Inside:* login, account balance, money transfer.

✓ *Outside:* ATM hardware, cash withdrawal.

➤ **Shows:** How the system interacts with users and its environment.

➤ **Example: Online banking system** → users log in, check balance, transfer money (but ATMs are not part of this system).

Understand and Evaluate Requirements (Specification & validation)

➤ Specification and validation

- ✓ Activity where the results of elicitation an analysis are formally captured and documented in an appropriate format for the use and review of all stakeholders.

Extra: Stakeholders review the classified requirements to ensure accuracy, completeness, and feasibility.

- ✓ When specifying requirements, it is important that each requirement exhibit certain characteristics desired for designing successful systems. **Requirements must be:**

Specific

Consistent

Correct

Attainable= "Achievable", Possible"

Complete

Verifiable

Understand and Evaluate Requirements

➤ On being **specific**,

- ✓ Requirements need to be specified in a clear, concise” **short and brief**,” and exclusive manner.
- ✓ Clear requirements are not open to interpretation; unclear or ambiguous requirements lead to incorrect designs, incorrect implementations, and deceptive validation during test.
- ✓ Concise requirements are brief and to the point and are therefore easier to understand.
- ✓ Exclusive requirements specify one, and only one thing, making them easier to verify.

Specific	Requirement
No	The software shall search the database.
Yes	The software shall search for a product using the product ID.
	The software shall be secure.
	The software shall authenticate users with user ID and password.
No	The software shall be secure and fast.
	The software shall authenticate users with user ID and password.
Yes	Server acknowledgment message shall be sent within 1/2 second from the time a request is received.

Search the database for what?

What does this mean?

Secure and fast?

These two requirements are specific and provide the information required to determine what secure and fast mean!

Example of specific and nonspecific requirements:

➤ **Extra: Specific Requirements Non-Specific Requirements:**

1. **“The software shall search for a product using the product ID.”**

✓ **Specific:** Yes, because it clearly states what needs to be searched (product) and how (using product ID).

2. **“The software shall authenticate users with user ID and password.”**

✓ **Specific:** Yes, as it specifies the authentication mechanism (user ID and password).

3. **“Server acknowledgment message shall be sent within 1/2 second from the time a request is received.”**

✓ **Specific:** Yes, it provides a measurable performance requirement (response time within 1/2 second).

4. **“The software shall search the database.”**

✓ **specific:** No, This is vague because it doesn't specify what to search for in the database. It lacks context and detail about the search criteria or the expected outcome.

5. **“The software shall be secure.”**

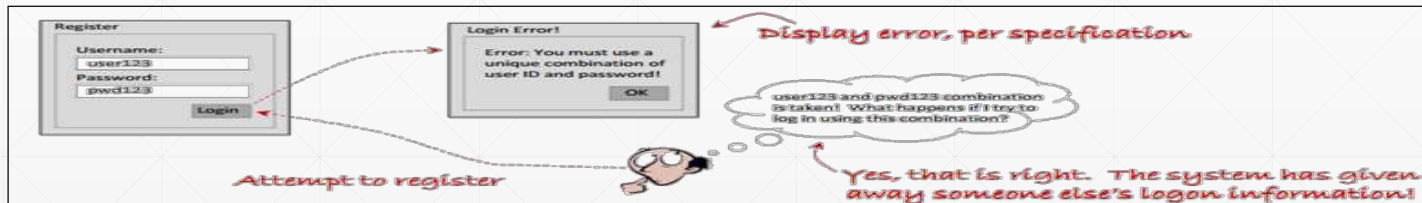
✓ **specific:** No, Security is a broad concept. This requirement doesn't specify what aspects of security are important, such as whether it refers to data encryption, secure user authentication, or another security measure.

6. **“The software shall be secure and fast.”**

✓ **specific:** No, This requirement combines two qualitative attributes—security and speed—without detailing what "secure" or "fast" means in measurable terms.

Understand and Evaluate Requirements

- On being **correct**,
 - ✓ Requirements need to be correct in the sense that they must accurately describe a desired system function.
 - ✓ Incorrect requirements can lead to incorrect or undesired behavior.
- The diagram you're describing seems to illustrate a sequence of interactions around user registration and login for a software system, highlighting an error handling scenario where a username and password combination is not unique. Here's a detailed breakdown based on the described elements:



Extra: Scenario Overview:

1. Attempt to Register:

A user tries to register with a username and password via a registration form.

2. Error Display:

The system checks if the username and password combination is unique.

Since the combination is already taken, the system generates an error message stating, "Error! You must use a unique combination of user ID and password!"

3. User's Reaction:

This prompts the user to either choose a different username or password to ensure uniqueness.

Understand and Evaluate Requirements

➤ On being **complete**,

- ✓ Requirements must be complete both individually and as collective set.
 - This means that each requirement should be specified thoroughly so that it absolutely describes the functions required to meet some need.
 - Collectively, requirements need to provide complete specification of the software's required functionality in the software requirements specification (SRS).
 - ❑ **Extra:**
 - Individually → each requirement should be fully detailed and clear.
 - Collectively → together, they should describe the entire functionality in the Software Requirements Specification (SRS).
- In short: Complete requirements = nothing missing, everything specified.
- ✓ Incomplete requirements lead to incomplete designs, which in turn leads to incomplete construction of the software system.

This is a good requirement in the sense that it is specific and correct.

Complete	Requirement
No	The software shall generate product reports.
Yes	The software shall generate product reports consisting of product description, picture, and price. Product reports shall be in PDF format.

Notice how the original requirement is broken into two complete requirements!

However, if we know the requirements for product reports, then a complete version of this requirement specifies this information. This help disambiguate the notion of a product report so that it can be implemented easily in code.

Understand and Evaluate Requirements

➤ On being **consistent**,

- ✓ Requirements are consistent when they do not preclude “prevent” the design or construction of other requirements.

➤ On being **attainable**,

- ✓ Requirements that are unattainable serve no purpose.
- ✓ Attainability can be determined for both product and process.
- ✓ Requirements are attainable if they can realistically be achieved within the project constraints, which include time, technology, budget, and resources.

Extra:

Consistent

- No conflicts between requirements.
- ✓ Example: “System must support online payments” & “System must support credit card payments” (work together).
- ✗ Conflict: “System must be offline only” & “System must support online payments.”

Attainable

- Realistic within time, budget, technology, resources.
- ✓ Example: “App must handle 1,000 users at once.”
- ✗ Not attainable: “App must handle 1 billion users on a \$500 budget.”

💡 **Tip:** Good requirements = **clear, non-conflicting, and realistic.**

Attainable	Requirement
No	The software shall execute on all future operating systems.
Yes	The software shall execute on the Microsoft Windows 7 platform.

Understand and Evaluate Requirements

Extra: A requirement is verifiable if there is a suitable way to measure or test it to confirm that the requirement has been met. This could be through tests, demonstrations

- On being **verifiable**,
 - ✓ Perhaps the most obvious desirable characteristic of requirements.
 - ✓ Requirements that cannot be verified cannot be claimed as met.
 - ✓ Inability to verify requirements point to a serious flaw early on in the development process

Verifiable	Requirement
No	The system shall maximize communication speed.
Yes	The system's data rate shall be no less than 1Mbps.

•**Extra:**

-  **Verifiable Requirements**
- **Good requirement** = measurable, testable, clear.
- **Bad requirement** = vague, not testable.
- **Examples:**
-  *Not verifiable:* “The system shall maximize speed.”
-  *Verifiable:* “The system’s data rate shall be at least **1 Mbps**.”
-  **Tip:** Always make requirements measurable → use **numbers, limits, or conditions**.

Summary

- In this session, we presented fundamentals concepts of **requirements engineering**, and provided enough information to successfully create good requirements.
 - In the next session, we'll discuss **how to design the software architecture using the popular 4+1 View Model**, which includes:
 - ✓ Logical view
 - ✓ Development View
 - ✓ Process View
 - ✓ Physical View
 - ✓ User View
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